Northbank Vulnerable Customer Procedure

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1. Purpose

Ensures customers in vulnerable circumstances receive outcomes as good as other customers, reflecting FCA guidance FG21/1 on the fair treatment of vulnerable customers.

2. Drivers of vulnerability

Driver	Examples of indicators in notes
Health	serious or long-term illness, hospital stay, mental health condition, anxiety, depression
Life events	bereavement, relationship breakdown, job loss or redundancy, becoming a carer
Resilience	sudden income drop, no savings, relying on credit for essentials
Capability	difficulty understanding letters, low digital or financial confidence

Indicators can be stated directly or implied. For example, 'I've been off work since the operation' implies a health driver even if the word illness is not used.

3. Required actions when an indicator is found

1. Record the indicator and set the case flag VULNERABILITY_REVIEW.

2. Refer to the Specialist Support Team within 2 business days.

3. Pause collections activity for 30 days and apply section 3 of the Forbearance and Arrears Procedure.

4. Offer communication adjustments (preferred channel, a named contact, more time to respond).

4. What not to do

Do not ask the customer for medical evidence as a condition of support. Do not issue a default notice or refer to Collections while a vulnerability review is open.